

What 126 Universities (Say They) Teach

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Abstract

This report extends the catalog-language analysis of Marinovic (2026), "What Universities (Say They) Teach," from its original 16-university comparison set to 126 U.S. institutions. Following the reference methodology, each course title and description is searched for two keyword families: a progressive signal (race, gender, identity, diversity, equity, social justice, decolonial, and related themes) and a Western-canon signal (classical antiquity, the Western intellectual tradition, canonical authors and texts). The sample combines 117 freshly collected catalogs - 110 regional/public/private institutions plus 7 of the original reference universities re-scraped from their current 2026 catalogs (Stanford, MIT, Cornell, Northwestern, NYU, UIUC, U. Iowa) - with the remaining 9 reference universities cited from Marinovic (2026) because their catalogs are dynamic-JS or proxy-blocked. Across the 117 collected catalogs - 785,518 deduplicated courses - the course-weighted progressive signal is 10.4% and the Western-canon signal is 2.8%. The central pattern of the original paper holds: the progressive signal exceeds the Western-canon signal at 122 of 126 institutions, typically by a factor of three to four. The signal is far from uniform - progressive shares range from 0.0% to over 34% - and the few institutions where the canon signal dominates are Christian colleges or low-signal outliers. These measures are mechanical keyword counts, not judgments about course quality or what is taught in classrooms.

1. Introduction

Marinovic (2026) measures how often U.S. university course catalogs use language associated with progressive themes versus the Western canon, documenting a steady rise in the progressive signal alongside a flat-to-declining canon signal, drawing its cross-sectional comparisons from sixteen major research universities. This report keeps the method fixed and asks a simpler question: what does the same measurement look like across a much wider slice of American higher education?

The 126 institutions here are deliberately heterogeneous - private research universities, large public flagships, regional public universities, technical institutes, religious colleges, and community colleges. The original sample explicitly omitted community colleges, regional public universities, and most liberal-arts colleges; this extension fills in exactly those gaps. The cost is that catalog coverage and description quality vary more across this sample than within the original sixteen. As in the reference report, this is a descriptive exercise: it asks only how often certain themes appear in the official language by which universities describe their courses.

2. Data and Method

Coverage. The report combines (i) 117 freshly collected catalogs scraped from each institution's current public catalog - almost all 2026-2027, 785,518 deduplicated courses - including 7 of the original reference universities re-scraped directly (Stanford via the ExploreCourses XML API; MIT, Northwestern, NYU, UIUC, U. Iowa via CourseleafCMS; Cornell via the Class Roster API); and (ii) 9 reference catalogs carried over from Marinovic (2026) - Berkeley, Harvard, Yale, Princeton, U. Chicago, Columbia, Vanderbilt, UT Austin, Texas A&M - whose catalogs are dynamic-JS apps or blocked from the collection environment and could not be re-scraped.

Keyword matching. Matching is case-insensitive substring matching against the same progressive and Western-canon keyword lists used throughout this project (drawn from Tables 2-3 of the reference paper). A course carries a signal if its combined title-plus-description contains at least one keyword from the corresponding list. Cross-listed duplicates are collapsed to one course-year before any share is computed. The two signals are not mutually exclusive.

Caveats: (1) Single-year snapshot - the collected catalogs are observed in one recent catalog year, so this is a cross-section, not a panel. (2) Coarser area classification - broad areas are assigned by a mechanical department/title keyword map, so the residual "Other" category is large and should be read as "unclassified." (3) Full catalog, no enrollment weights - all shares are unweighted course counts over the full published catalog. The paper's headline figures restrict to offered/enrolled courses and use word-boundary matching, so re-scraped values here run higher than its published numbers (quantified in section 4.4).

3. Headline Findings

- The progressive signal dominates the canon signal almost everywhere. At 122 of 126 institutions the progressive share exceeds the Western-canon share. Across the 117 collected catalogs the course-weighted progressive signal (10.4%) is about 3.7x the canon signal (2.8%).
- Typical magnitudes are well below the elite tail. The median institution carries the progressive signal on 9.4% of courses and the canon signal on 2.2%. The most progressive catalogs - Stanford and the elite privates - sit in the upper tail of the full distribution, not at its center.
- Enormous dispersion. Progressive shares span roughly 0.0% to 34% (standard deviation 6.3 points). The spread is institutional, not just disciplinary: regional and technical schools cluster low, while research universities and several small private colleges cluster high.
- Where the canon wins, it is usually religious. Only 3 institutions carry more canonical than progressive language: Biola, Cornerstone, Marshall. Biola and Cornerstone are Christian colleges; Marshall is an outlier whose unusually low progressive share reflects short, sparse catalog descriptions rather than a canon-heavy curriculum.
- Climate language is modest but pervasive. Across collected catalogs the narrow climate signal averages 0.6% of courses and the broad climate-or-sustainability signal 2.8%.

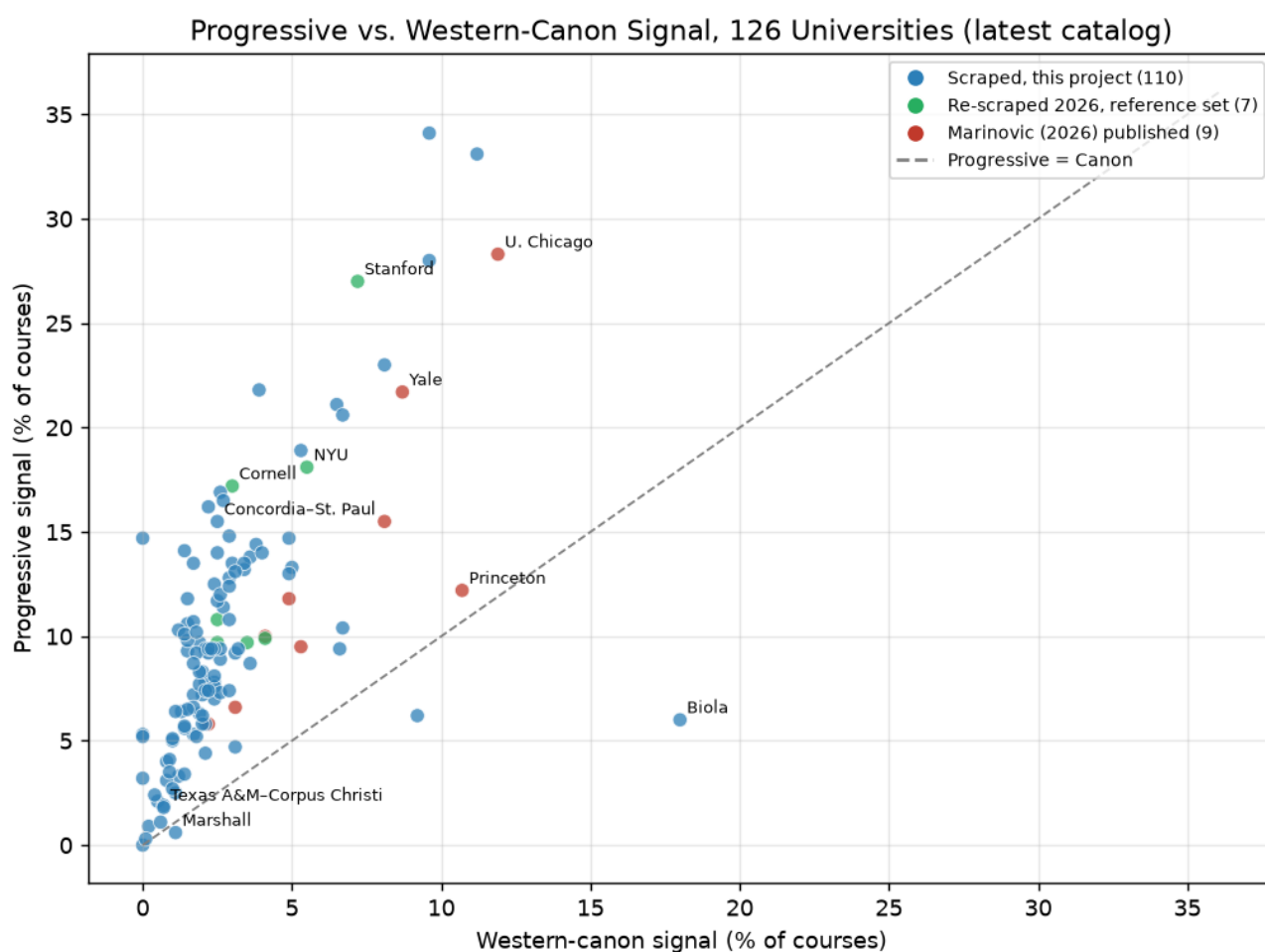


Figure 1. Each point is one institution's latest catalog. Points above the dashed line carry more progressive than canonical language. Blue = 110 regional/public/private catalogs; green = 7 re-scraped 2026 reference catalogs; red = 9 reference catalogs cited from Marinovic (2026).

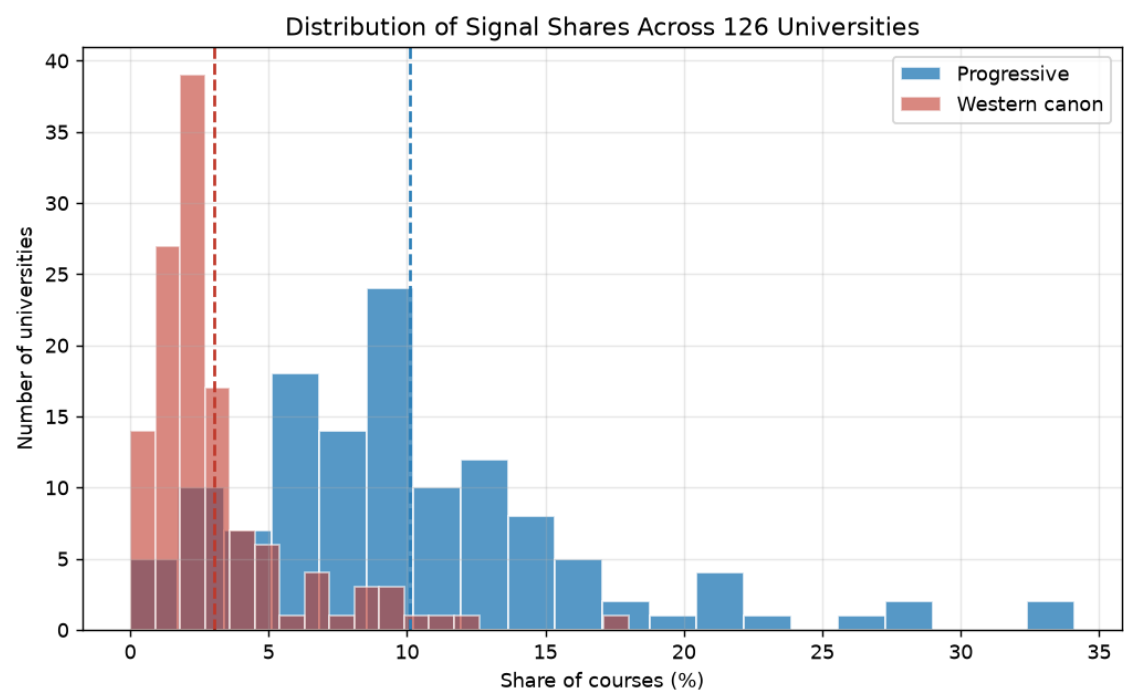


Figure 2. Distribution of progressive and Western-canon shares across all 126 institutions. Dashed lines mark the means.

4. Cross-Sectional Comparison (all 126 institutions)

Table 1 reports every institution's latest-catalog progressive and Western-canon shares, the ratio between them, and the number of courses analyzed. As in Table 6 of the reference paper, institutions are sorted from the highest progressive-to-canon ratio to the lowest.

#	University	Year	Courses	Prog. %	Canon %	P/C	Src
1	U. New England	2026	2,070	14.1	1.4	10.07	sc
2	Oregon State	2026	8,469	10.3	1.2	8.58	sc
3	Alverno	2026	1,044	13.5	1.7	7.94	sc
4	Worcester State	2026	1,767	11.8	1.5	7.87	sc
5	Utah Tech	2026	2,117	16.2	2.2	7.36	sc
6	U. Northern Iowa	2026	1,750	10.1	1.4	7.21	sc
7	Northeastern	2026	7,966	10.6	1.5	7.07	sc
8	Cal Poly SLO	2026	4,210	9.8	1.5	6.53	sc
9	Northeastern Illinois	2026	3,558	16.9	2.6	6.50	sc
10	UW-Eau Claire	2026	2,998	10.7	1.7	6.29	sc
11	U. New Mexico	2026	6,470	9.3	1.5	6.20	sc
12	Concordia-St. Paul	2026	1,575	15.5	2.5	6.20	sc
13	Mt. Wachusett CC	2026	448	16.5	2.7	6.11	sc
14	U. Northern Colorado	2026	3,304	2.4	0.4	6.00	sc
15	Illinois Tech	2026	3,221	6.4	1.1	5.82	sc
16	Cornell	2026	4,459	17.2	3.0	5.73	re
17	UW-Platteville	2026	1,195	10.2	1.8	5.67	sc
18	Purdue	2027	17,390	14.0	2.5	5.60	sc
19	Case Western	2026	5,466	21.8	3.9	5.59	sc
20	U. Wisconsin-Madison	2026	10,142	12.5	2.4	5.21	sc
21	UW-Green Bay	2026	1,340	8.7	1.7	5.12	sc
22	U. Louisville	2026	6,470	9.7	1.9	5.11	sc
23	U. Alaska Fairbanks	2026	3,794	9.2	1.8	5.11	sc
24	U. Idaho (UG)	2026	4,946	5.1	1.0	5.10	sc
25	CSU Bakersfield	2026	2,461	14.8	2.9	5.10	sc
26	UConn	2026	7,067	4.0	0.8	5.00	sc
27	U. Idaho	2026	5,160	5.0	1.0	5.00	sc
28	Drexel	2026	8,329	6.4	1.3	4.92	sc
29	U. Maryland	2026	9,235	11.7	2.5	4.68	sc
30	Temple	2026	12,782	12.0	2.6	4.62	sc
31	West Virginia	2026	10,192	4.1	0.9	4.56	sc
32	Carnegie Mellon	2027	3,174	0.9	0.2	4.50	sc
33	UCSD	2026	6,925	13.5	3.0	4.50	sc
34	UT San Antonio	2026	5,867	9.4	2.1	4.48	sc
35	Virginia Tech	2026	7,685	9.3	2.1	4.43	sc
36	U. Minnesota	2026	25,682	12.8	2.9	4.41	sc
37	Virginia State	2026	2,333	8.3	1.9	4.37	sc
38	Montana State	2026	4,443	6.5	1.5	4.33	sc
39	U. Iowa	2026	9,137	10.8	2.5	4.32	re
40	Texas State	2026	5,980	12.4	2.9	4.28	sc
41	Keene State	2026	1,006	9.4	2.2	4.27	sc
42	Iowa State	2026	8,242	7.2	1.7	4.24	sc
43	U. Kansas	2026	8,495	13.1	3.1	4.23	sc
44	U. Washington	2026	15,673	11.4	2.7	4.22	sc
45	Rutgers	2027	6,617	2.1	0.5	4.20	sc
46	UNC Greensboro	2026	5,890	9.2	2.2	4.18	sc

47	UT Arlington	2026	7,016	8.3	2.0	4.15	sc
48	UAB	2026	3,556	9.4	2.3	4.09	sc
49	Lamar	2026	2,346	5.7	1.4	4.07	sc
50	Old Dominion	2026	7,543	7.7	1.9	4.05	sc
51	Youngstown State	2026	4,345	5.6	1.4	4.00	sc
52	CU Boulder	2026	9,426	13.5	3.4	3.97	sc
53	U. Missouri	2026	11,338	9.4	2.4	3.92	sc
54	Snow College	2026	1,150	3.5	0.9	3.89	sc
55	UIUC	2026	9,439	9.7	2.5	3.88	re
56	Penn State	2026	14,505	13.2	3.4	3.88	sc
57	Mississippi State	2026	3,346	6.6	1.7	3.88	sc
58	Arkansas Tech	2026	2,794	3.1	0.8	3.88	sc
59	UCSB	2025	14,121	13.8	3.6	3.83	sc
60	UNC Chapel Hill	2026	10,664	14.4	3.8	3.79	sc
61	Stanford	2026	15,668	27.0	7.2	3.75	re
62	Tulane	2026	8,960	10.8	2.9	3.72	sc
63	U. Oregon	2026	6,007	7.8	2.1	3.71	sc
64	UC Irvine	2026	5,354	9.4	2.6	3.62	sc
65	U. Arizona	2026	38,659	7.2	2.0	3.60	sc
66	Fairfield	2026	2,631	18.9	5.3	3.57	sc
67	Dartmouth	2026	4,116	34.1	9.6	3.55	sc
68	Utah Valley	2026	4,292	7.4	2.1	3.52	sc
69	Boston University	2026	3,564	14.0	4.0	3.50	sc
70	UC Davis	2026	9,883	8.9	2.6	3.42	sc
71	NC State	2026	7,761	8.1	2.4	3.38	sc
72	Washburn	2026	2,746	7.4	2.2	3.36	sc
73	Oklahoma State	2026	7,551	6.3	1.9	3.32	sc
74	NYU	2026	16,829	18.1	5.5	3.29	re
75	U. Penn	2026	11,142	21.1	6.5	3.25	sc
76	U. Georgia	2026	13,374	7.8	2.4	3.25	sc
77	U. Nebraska-Lincoln	2026	9,954	7.6	2.4	3.17	sc
78	Colorado State	2026	4,048	5.3	1.7	3.12	sc
79	Sam Houston State	2026	1,966	6.2	2.0	3.10	sc
80	Georgetown	2017	4,191	20.6	6.7	3.07	sc
81	Johns Hopkins	2026	10,248	14.7	4.9	3.00	sc
82	Oregon Tech	2027	4,440	0.3	0.1	3.00	sc
83	U. Alabama	2026	6,641	9.2	3.1	2.97	sc
84	Notre Dame	2026	9,536	33.1	11.2	2.96	sc
85	Texas A&M International	2026	1,990	9.4	3.2	2.94	sc
86	Brown	2026	11,480	28.0	9.6	2.92	sc
87	George Washington	2026	7,827	7.0	2.4	2.92	sc
88	UW-Milwaukee	2026	7,006	5.8	2.0	2.90	sc
89	UT Dallas	2026	5,121	5.2	1.8	2.89	sc
90	WashU	2026	7,714	23.0	8.1	2.84	sc
91	U. Miami	2026	9,882	7.3	2.6	2.81	sc
92	MIT	2025	5,918	9.7	3.5	2.77	re
93	U. Montana	2026	4,400	5.8	2.1	2.76	sc
94	Auburn	2026	7,072	3.3	1.2	2.75	sc
95	Kansas State	2026	20,938	1.9	0.7	2.71	sc
96	Western Kentucky	2026	3,083	2.7	1.0	2.70	sc
97	Rice	2026	6,470	13.3	5.0	2.66	sc
98	Indiana University	2026	4,625	13.0	4.9	2.65	sc

99	Texas A&M	2024	50,135*	5.8	2.2	2.64	pap
100	Texas A&M-Corpus Christi	2026	2,043	1.8	0.7	2.57	sc
101	U. Nebraska-Kearney	2026	2,667	7.4	2.9	2.55	sc
102	Yale	2025	35,205*	21.7	8.7	2.49	pap
103	UC Berkeley	2025	191,558*	10.0	4.1	2.44	pap
104	North Dakota State	2026	5,596	3.4	1.4	2.43	sc
105	U. Florida	2026	4,929	8.7	3.6	2.42	sc
106	Northwestern	2026	1,715	9.9	4.1	2.41	re
107	Vanderbilt	2025	58,999*	11.8	4.9	2.41	pap
108	U. Chicago	2024	21,381*	28.3	11.9	2.38	pap
109	Georgia Tech	2026	5,332	2.5	1.1	2.27	sc
110	UT Austin	2025	47,739*	6.6	3.1	2.13	pap
111	Colorado Mesa	2026	2,985	4.4	2.1	2.10	sc
112	Columbia	2025	24,674*	15.5	8.1	1.91	pap
113	Texas Southern	2026	2,065	1.1	0.6	1.83	sc
114	Harvard	2025	120,567*	9.5	5.3	1.79	pap
115	Vanguard	2026	1,368	10.4	6.7	1.55	sc
116	Emory	2026	3,607	4.7	3.1	1.52	sc
117	George Mason	2026	8,248	9.4	6.6	1.42	sc
118	Princeton	2025	24,118*	12.2	10.7	1.14	pap
119	Cornerstone	2026	1,276	6.2	9.2	0.67	sc
120	Marshall	2026	3,216	0.6	1.1	0.55	sc
121	Biola	2026	2,754	6.0	18.0	0.33	sc
122	Wake Forest	2026	2,436	14.7	0.0	-	sc
123	Florida State	2026	12,179	5.3	0.0	-	sc
124	U. Utah	2027	18,155	0.0	0.0	-	sc
125	U. Pittsburgh	2026	5,289	3.2	0.0	-	sc
126	Baylor	2026	6,438	5.2	0.0	-	sc

Src: sc = scraped this project; re = reference university re-scraped from its 2026 catalog; pap = carried over from Marinovic (2026). * For the 9 pap rows the course count is total course-years in that paper, not a single year; shares are its latest-year (2024/2025) values. Collected counts are deduplicated single-year (mostly 2026-2027).

4.4 Re-scraped reference universities: 2026 catalog vs. published figures

Seven of the sixteen original reference universities could be re-scraped from their live 2026 catalogs. The table below places the freshly scraped shares next to the values Marinovic (2026) reported. The re-scraped numbers run consistently higher for two structural reasons: this project scrapes the entire published catalog (vs. the paper restricting to offered/enrolled courses), and it uses substring matching (vs. the paper's word-boundary matching). The gap is a methodological artifact, not evidence the catalogs changed; relative ordering is largely preserved. Northwestern is undergraduate-only here.

University	2026 Prog %	Paper Prog %	2026 Canon %	Paper Canon %	2026 courses
Stanford	27.0	14.3	7.2	4.2	15,668
NYU	18.1	15.7	5.5	11.9	16,829
Cornell	17.2	15.3	3.0	4.4	4,459
U. Iowa	10.8	8.3	2.5	2.4	9,137
Northwestern	9.9	9.1	4.1	3.2	1,715
UIUC	9.7	6.5	2.5	1.9	9,439
MIT	9.7	7.8	3.5	3.7	5,918

Progressive Signal Ranking, 126 Universities

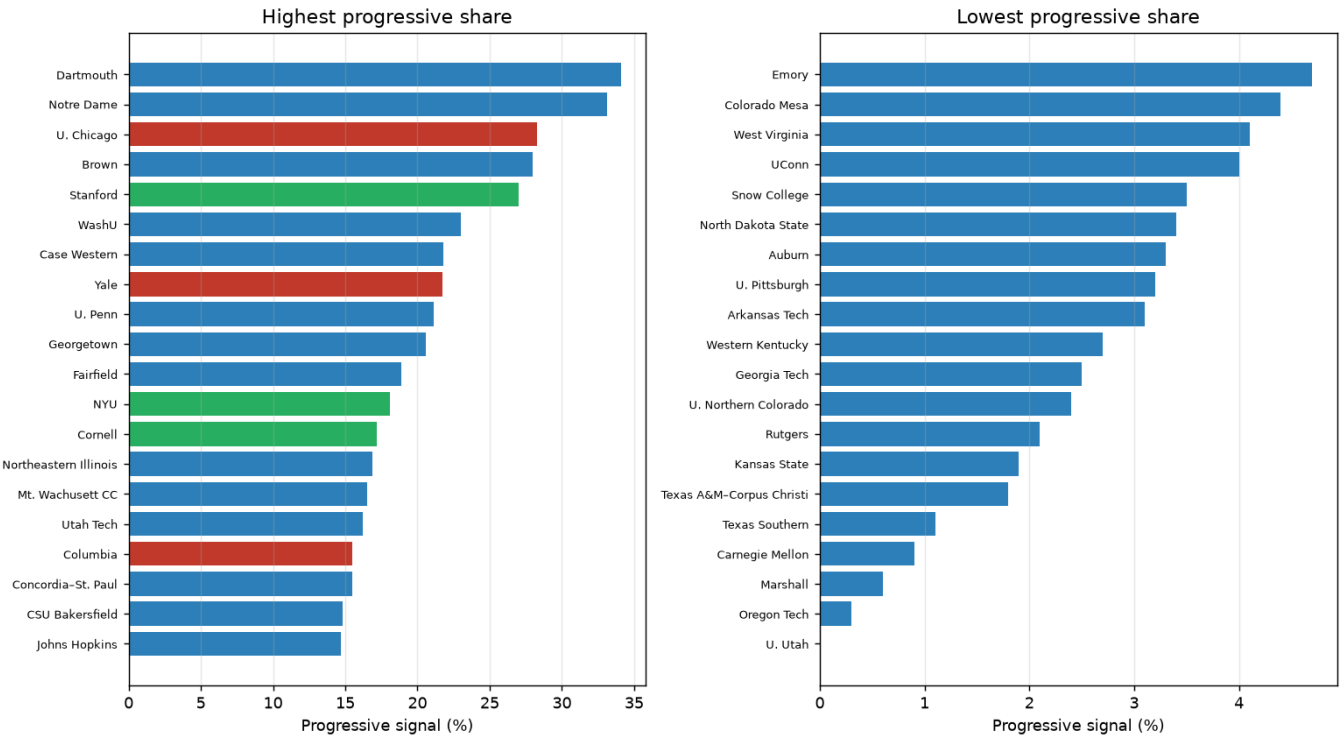


Figure 3. The twenty highest and twenty lowest institutions by progressive share.

5. Catalog Composition

Universities differ in the mix of courses they offer, which shapes baseline exposure to each keyword list. The table below aggregates broad-area composition across the 117 collected catalogs. The large "Other" share reflects the coarse keyword-based area classifier used in this extension and should be read as "unclassified."

Broad area	Courses	Share of catalog
Humanities	127,166	17.6%
Social Sciences	69,450	9.6%
STEM	122,010	16.9%
Medical Sciences	24,456	3.4%
Professional	57,109	7.9%
Other	321,156	44.5%
Total	721,347	100.0%

In the reference paper the progressive signal concentrates in the Social Sciences and Professional schools, the canon signal in the Humanities, and both are lowest in STEM. The institution-level results are consistent with that pattern: the highest progressive shares are humanities- and social-science-heavy private colleges and flagships, the lowest are technical and applied institutions.

6. Climate-Related Language

Following Appendix C of the reference paper, climate language is measured separately. A narrow signal captures climate change, global warming, greenhouse gas, carbon emissions, and similar; a broad signal adds sustainability, renewable energy, and clean energy. The fifteen collected institutions with the highest broad climate share are shown below.

#	University	Narrow %	Broad %
1	Stanford	3.4	8.9
2	U. New England	2.3	8.5
3	Cornell	2.3	7.3
4	Notre Dame	3.4	7.1
5	MIT	2.4	6.3
6	CU Boulder	1.4	6.1
7	Cal Poly SLO	1.3	5.9
8	Iowa State	0.8	5.8
9	Virginia Tech	1.0	5.8
10	Johns Hopkins	2.4	5.8
11	Texas State	0.2	5.7
12	Oregon State	1.2	5.6
13	U. Alaska Fairbanks	1.2	5.5
14	U. Idaho	0.5	5.2
15	U. Idaho (UG)	0.5	5.2

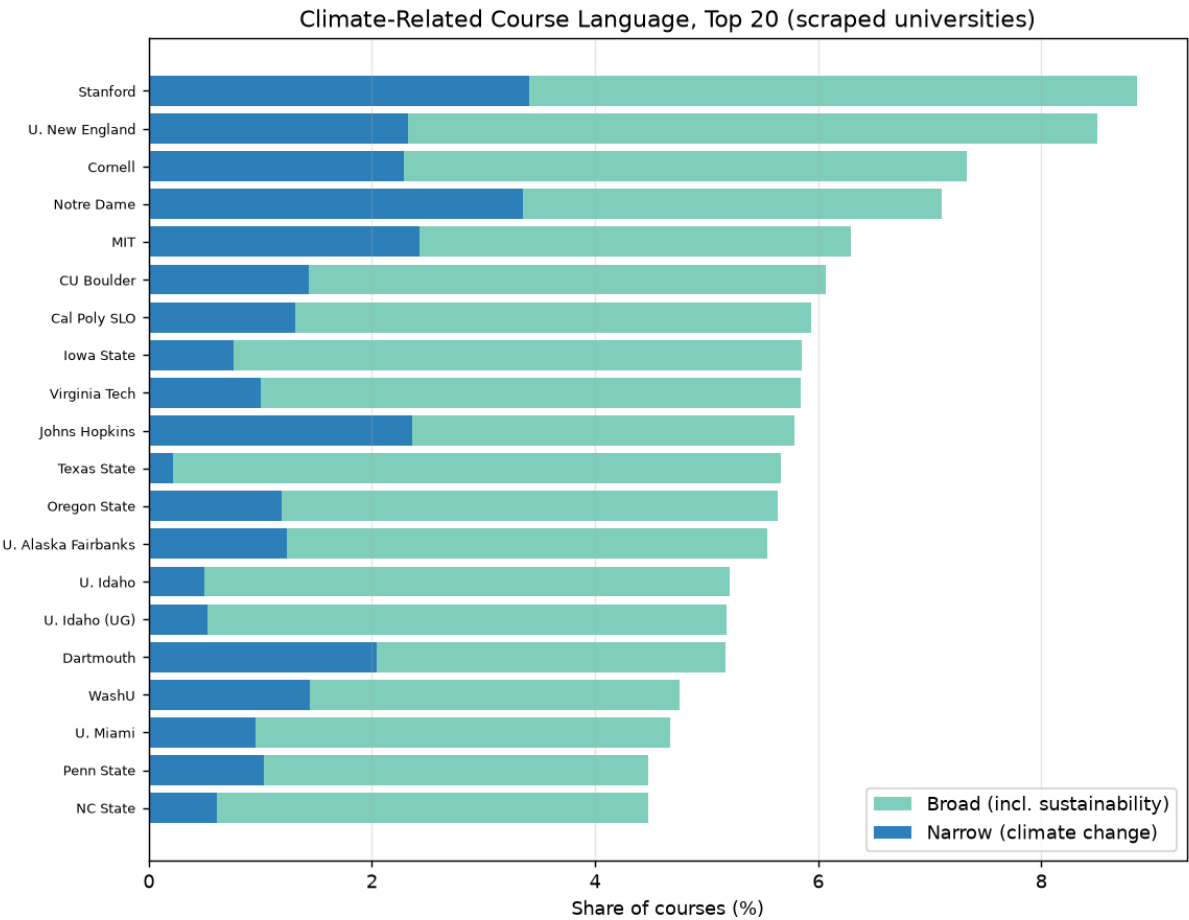


Figure 4. Top 20 collected institutions by broad climate-or-sustainability share; dark bars show the narrow climate-change signal within each.

7. Limitations and Conclusion

Catalogs are not classrooms: keyword counts on public descriptions do not reveal what is assigned, how a course is taught, or what students learn. Substring keyword matching produces false positives (race in "race car," equity in finance, classical in physics) and false negatives. The re-scraped reference values are not directly comparable to the paper's published figures (full catalog + substring here vs. offered-subset + word-boundary there); they ARE comparable to the other collected catalogs. 9 reference universities could not be re-scraped and retain paper values; Northwestern is undergraduate-only.

Extending the measurement from 16 to 126 institutions - and re-scraping 7 reference universities from their 2026 catalogs - does not overturn the central finding of Marinovic (2026): progressive language is far more common than Western-canon language in the stated curriculum, dominating at 122 of 126 schools. What the wider sample adds is context for magnitude. The very high progressive shares of the most-discussed elite catalogs are not representative of American higher education as a whole; the median institution sits near 9%, with a long tail of regional, technical, and religious institutions below that. The institutions where the canon still leads are a small, distinctive group - Christian colleges, plus one low-signal outlier. As in the original, these are rough, comparable signals offered for transparency and replication, not verdicts on any institution.

Reference: Ivan Marinovic, "What Universities (Say They) Teach," Stanford University, June 2026. Per-institution data: data/<uni>/<uni>_<year>.csv and <uni>_summary.json. Keyword lists and schema: schema.md. Catalog status of all targets: progress.json.